The Boyhood Adventures of Clark Kent: Episode One

by Anthony Doyle



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NARRATOR. When it comes to American stories, most of the really good ones take place in Kansas. This is how we know they're fictional, because nothing really good actually happens in Kansas. This story starts in Kansas in 1952, when an honest and hardworking farmer named Jonathan Kent heard an explosion one morning. Jonathan and his wife Martha wandered out into the middle of the field and found an enormous crater.

JONATHAN. Holy hole!

MARTHA. Oh, Jonathan! Look!

NARRATOR. Inside the crater there was a strange metal sphere.

JONATHAN. Oh god, it's that Sputnik devil sent by the Commies! Martha! Get the bible!

NARRATOR. But when Martha approached she noticed something. It wasn't a Soviet satellite. It was a little space ship and inside was…

MARTHA. A baby! Oh Jonathan! It's a baby, just for us!

JONATHAN. What kind of Commie stork delivers Commie babies in space ships?

NARRATOR. But in spite of Jonathan's reservations he and Martha adopted the baby and named him.

MARTHA. How about Allen?

JONATHAN. It sounds too much like alien.

MARTHA. Rich?

JONATHAN. Let's not be ironical, Martha.

MARTHA. How about Clark?

JONATHAN. Clark Kent. That sounds downright American.

MARTHA. Little Clark Kent, my son.

NARRATOR. As the three settled into their quiet Kansas life together, Jonathan and Martha soon realized their child wasn't like other children.

JONATHAN. See here, Clark. This is a hammer.

CLARK. (*CLARK sneezes and rips it in half.*)

JONATHAN. Oh my.

NARRATOR. With the help of Jonathan, Clark soon found that he had extreme strength and speed. He had the ability to fly. And they even discovered that Clark was bullet proof, a discovery that got Jonathan in a lot of trouble with Martha. But one day, while Clark was plowing the field with just his fingers, he told his Dad what he wanted more than anything else.

CLARK. Dad, I want to be a boy scout.

JONATHAN. Why's that son?

CLARK. They get badges on their chest for doing good things. I want that too.

JONATHAN. That the only reason?
CLARK. Chicks dig badges.
JONATHAN. An American answer! Nice! (*They high five each other.*) AH! (*JONATHAN recoils in pain.*)
NARRATOR. Well, after Jonathan returned from the hospital, he told Martha all about Clark and the boy scouts.
JONATHAN. (*arm in a sling*) Isn't it wonderful, Martha?
MARTHA. Clark, sweetie, are you sure you want to do this? It's not going to be easy.
CLARK. I'm sure.
NARRATOR. So off he went to boy scout camp.
SCOUT LEADER. Welcome to The Kansas Boy Scouts of America Cam, or as we like to call it, KaB SAC. This is where boys go to become scouts. So the question is: Are you ready?
CLARK. (*enthusiastic)* YES!
SCOUT LEADER. Oh sorry, that was a rhetorical question. But I like your spirit, scout. What's your name?
CLARK. Clark Kent.
SCOUT LEADER. That sounds downright American! Well, I suppose you'd better meet your fellow scouts. Sound off!
TWITCH. Twitchy!
SLOBBER. (*gargling and lisping sounds*)
CHUBS. Chubs!
BUG EYES. I'm Bug Eyes!
NARRATOR. The other boys looked like Clark, well, except for Bug Eyes. He looked like a bug. No matter how he tried, Clark just couldn't seem to fit in with them.
TWITCH. Clark! Wanna arm wrestle?
CLARK. Sure! (*accidentally rips off boy's arm*) Oops.
TWITCH. (*screams)* Ah!
NARRATOR. No one invited Clark to arm wrestling after that. In fact, no one invited Clark to do anything. That wasn't so bad. Soon it came time to test for badges. Clark was excited.
CLARK. So excited!
NARRATOR. First up is the fire badge test.
SCOUT LEADER. For the fire badge, rub your two sticks together to make fire.
CLARK. (*CLARK rubs the sticks together unsuccessfully. Then he uses his heat vision to light the fire.*) Done!
NARRATOR. The other boy scouts were upset.
SLOBBER. (*SLOBBER gargles and lisps while pointing at CLARK.*)
SCOUT LEADER. What?
SLOBBER. (*SLOBBER continues to gargle and lisp, then re-enacts CLARK lighting the fire with his eyes.*)

SCOUT LEADER. Um, right. Anyway, Clark, you didn't do it right, so no badge for you.

CLARK. Darn.

NARRATOR. Clark tried again with the metal working badge.

CLARK. (*bends it with his fingers*) Done!

NARRATOR. The other boy scouts were mad.

TWITCH. Scout Leader!

SCOUT LEADER. Settle down, it must not be real metal (*hits it, it hurts*) Ow!

NARRATOR. Once again, Clark had failed.

CLARK. Darn it.

NARRATOR. Finally, it was time for the archery badge test.

CLARK. (*releases the arrow*) Oops, that's going to miss, hang on. (*runs and catches the arrow*) I'll try again.

NARRATOR. The other boy scouts were furious.

BUG EYES. You're cheating!

CLARK. Cheating? How?

BUG EYES. You're a freak.

NARRATOR. With that, they sent Clark home without any badges. When Clark got home he told his parents what happened.

JONATHAN. Cheating?! It's not your fault you have Commie superpowers!

CLARK. I didn't mean to do it wrong.

MARTHA. You didn't do it wrong, sweetheart. Just different.

CLARK. Well, I guess different doesn't get you badges.

NARRATOR. The next morning when Clark came downstairs to breakfast, Martha was waiting.

MARTHA. Clark, the world can be a hard place for people who do things differently. I'm proud of you for being who you are. And you did earn a very special badge.

CLARK. I did?

MARTHA. You earned this badge. I made it for you, for being different.

CLARK. Does the "S" stand for special?

MARTHA. I think the "S" stands for super.

LOIS. Hey Clark

CLARK. Hey Lois

LOIS. Nice badge.

JONATHAN. Nice! (*He gives CLARK a high five with his other hand.*) AH! (*recoils in pain)*

NARRATOR. Clark would grow up and face many challenge for being different. He always wore that badge to remind himself and others that sometimes being different isn't just good, it's super.